

Singer of Life

Text: From a Texcoco Nahuatl poem

Music: Plains Indian traditional, 1879

LACQUIPARLE irregular

The musical score is written on three staves in 2/2 time, with a key signature of three flats (B-flat, E-flat, A-flat). The first staff begins with a B-flat major chord (Bbm) and contains the first two lines of the poem. The second staff begins with a B-flat major chord (Bbm) and contains the next two lines. The third staff begins with a B-flat major chord (Bbm) and contains the final two lines. Chord changes are indicated by Bbm, Ebm, and Bbm above the staves. The lyrics are written below the notes, with some words hyphenated across lines. The score ends with a double bar line.

Bbm Ebm Bbm

1 Sing - er of Life, all flow - ers are songs, with pet - als do you write.
2 Mor - tal are we, with all liv - ing things, with ea - gles in the sky.

Bbm Ebm Bbm

Sing - er of Life, you col - or the earth, daz - zling the eye with birds red and bright.
E - ven all gold and jade will not last; sing - ing a - lone, I know, can - not die.

Bbm Ebm Bbm

Joy is for us! The flow - ers are spread! Sing - ing is our de - light!
Here in this house of spring - time be - stow songs that like birds can fly.